

# MOTIVATION

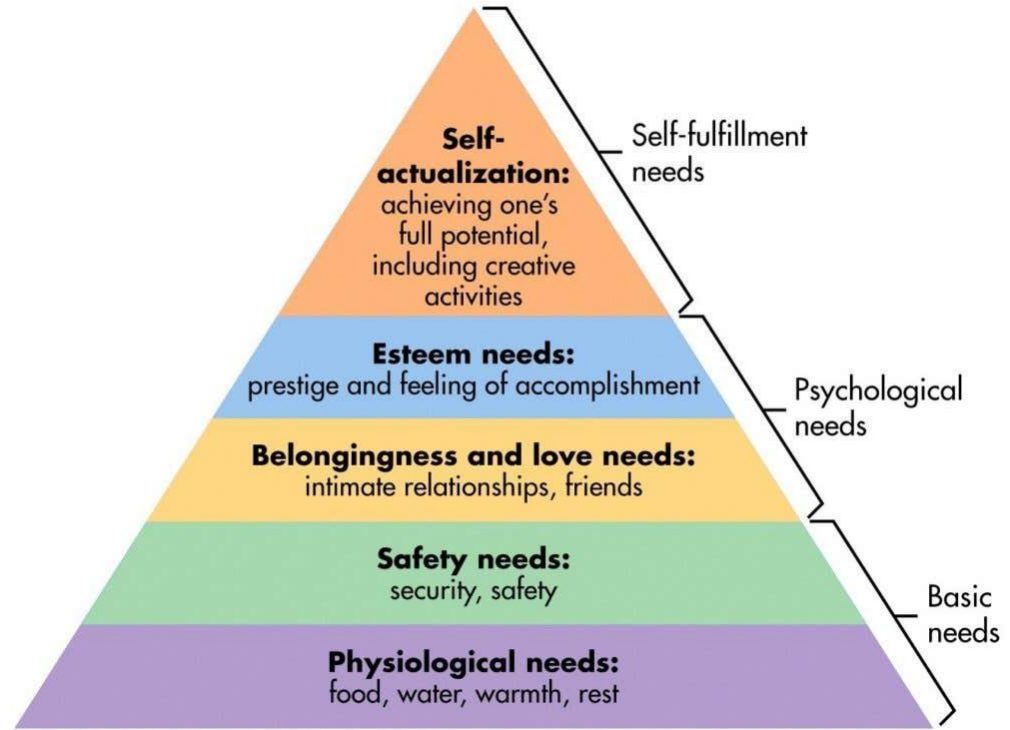
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# Psychosocial Needs: Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

- Human needs are arranged in a **hierarchy**
- Needs lower down in the hierarchy must be satisfied before individuals can attend to needs higher up
- Basic needs: physiological and short term
- Higher needs: psychological and long-term
- Higher the hierarchy, more difficult to satisfy



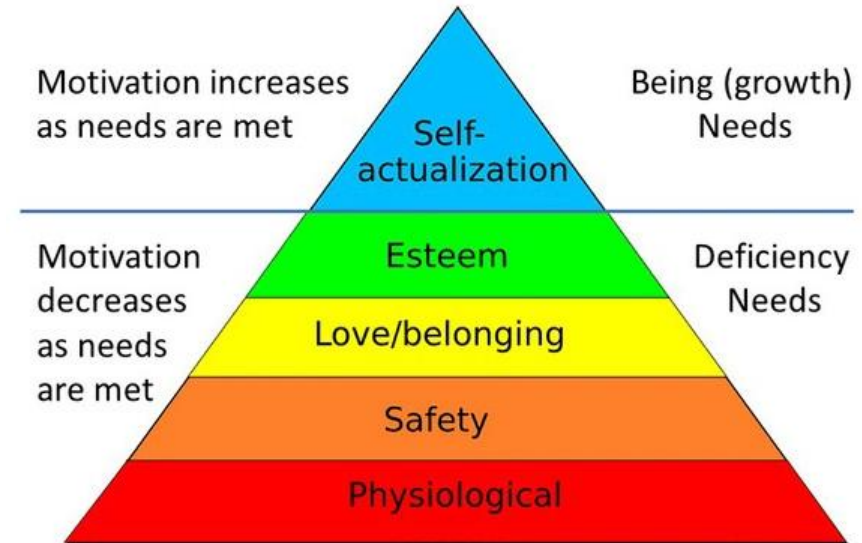
# Psychosocial Needs: Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs (cont'd)

## Growth needs:

- Maslow called the needs at the top of the pyramid growth needs
- These needs don't stem from a lack of something, but rather from a desire to grow as a person

## Deficiency needs:

- Deprivation; means to an end
- Physiological, security, social, and esteem needs are deficiency needs, which arise due to deprivation
- Satisfying these lower-level needs is important to avoid unpleasant feelings or consequences



# Psychosocial Needs: Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs (cont'd)

- **Physiological Needs:** Eating regular meals, getting enough sleep, staying hydrated during exams.
- **Safety Needs:** Feeling safe on campus, having financial aid or scholarships, access to healthcare services.
- **Love and Belongingness Needs:** Making friends in class or dorms, joining clubs or study groups, having supportive roommates.
- **Esteem Needs:** Receiving good grades, getting praise from professors, feeling confident in presentations or projects.
- **Self-Actualization:** Exploring interests through electives, engaging in meaningful research, developing talents, setting career goals

Basic Stuff Like Eating Spaghetti

# Psychosocial Needs: Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs (cont'd)

## Strengths:

- **Widely Applicable:** Fields like education, business, and healthcare to understand and improve human motivation and well-being
- **Focus on Positive Potential:** Highlights human growth and self-actualization rather than just problems or deficiencies

## Criticisms

- **Cultural Bias:** The focus on individual self-actualization reflects Western, individualistic values and may not apply well in collectivist cultures that prioritize social needs differently
- **Rigid Hierarchy Questioned:** People don't always follow a strict order; sometimes higher needs are pursued even if lower needs are unmet (e.g., artists pursuing creativity despite hardship)
- **Oversimplification:** Human motivation is complex and fluid

# Psychosocial Needs: McClelland's Acquired Needs Theory

## Need for affiliation

- Need for friendly social interactions and relationships with others
- Need to be liked by others, high regard by people

## Need for power

- Need for control or influence over other people
- Status and prestige: own expensive stuff; money

## Need for achievement

- Strong desire to succeed
- Desire for challenges and achievement for attaining goals

# Psychosocial Needs: McClelland's Acquired Needs Theory (cont'd...)

## Strengths:

- **Flexible:** Acknowledges that different people prioritize different needs (achievement, power, affiliation) which can change over time

## Drawbacks:

- **Simplifies human motivation:** Reduces motivation to three main needs, ignoring other possible motivational factors like security or self-actualization
- **Cultural limitations:** The dominance of certain needs may vary across cultures, limiting universal applicability

# References

- Ciccarelli, S. K., White, J. N., & Misra, G. (2017). *Psychology* (5th ed.). Pearson Education India.

**Gifs, memes, images, supplementary reading resources, & icons taken from:**

- <https://imgflip.com/memegenerator>
- <https://www.flaticon.com>
- <https://www.simplypsychology.org/>

# The Psychology of Emotion: I Feel, Therefore I Am

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# What if we didn't have emotions?

- **Decision-Making**
  - Without emotion– no value weighting
  - Decisions become computational but indecisive
- **Social Relationships**
  - No empathy, love, guilt
  - Relationships become purely functional
  - Breakdown of bonding and trust
- **Motivation**
  - No desire, fear, reward anticipation
  - Why study? Why avoid harm?
- **Survival**
  - Fear– threat detection
  - Disgust– disease avoidance
  - Without these– reduced survival

# What are emotions

**Emotion** is the "feeling" aspect of consciousness, characterized by three elements: physiological arousal, expressive behavior, and inner awareness of the feeling.

## **Three components of emotions:**

- Physiological experience of emotions
- Cognitive experience of emotions
- Behavioral expression of emotions

(Nevid, 2009; Myers, 2010)

# Bodily Arousal

- Activation of ANS
- Strong emotions – nervous system activation
- Release of hormones (epinephrine & norepinephrine) – increase alertness



**Autonomic Nervous System Controls Physiological Arousal**

| Sympathetic division (arousing) |                | Parasympathetic division (calming)    |
|---------------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------|
| Pupils dilate                   | EYES           | Pupils contract                       |
| Decreases                       | SALIVATION     | Increases                             |
| Perspires                       | SKIN           | Dries                                 |
| Increases                       | RESPIRATION    | Decreases                             |
| Accelerates                     | HEART          | Slows                                 |
| Inhibits                        | DIGESTION      | Activates                             |
| Secrete stress hormones         | ADRENAL GLANDS | Decrease secretion of stress hormones |

# Cognition (appraisal and experience)

- Interpreting the subjective feeling by giving it a label:
  - Anger, fear, disgust, happiness, sadness, shame, interest, etc.
- *Cognitive element* involves retrieving memories of previous similar experiences, perceiving the context of the emotion, and coming up with a solution, **a label**.
- Interpretation of situation (threat vs harmless)
  - Example:** Rubber snake – startle – its fake – no fear
- The label a person applies to a subjective feeling is at least in part a learned response influenced by their language and culture.
- Labeling is learned: Labels for emotions may differ in people of different cultural backgrounds, shaped by language and social context.

**Research shows that even the subjective feeling of happiness varies by culture:**

## **Japanese Students**

Associated positive emotional state with friendly or socially engaged feelings (collectivistic)

## **US Students**

Associated positive state with socially disengaged feelings like pride (individualistic)

# Behavioural expression

- Approach: Joy, love, anger (move toward/  
attack)
- Avoidance: fear disgust (withdraw/ flee)
- Expressed through: facial expression, tone of  
voice, body posture

(Nevid, 2009; Myers, 2010)



**Anger**

**Furrowed brows, clenched jaw**



**Happiness**

**Smile, eye crinkle**



**Fear**

**Wide eyes, raised brows**



**Surprise**

**Raised brows, open mouth**



**Disgust**

**Nose wrinkle, lip curl**



**Sadness**

**Downturned mouth, tears**



**Contempt**

**One-sided smile**



**Love**

**Soft eyes, smile**

# Universal emotions

- These universalists believed that emotions evolved as a response to the environments of our primordial ancestors, so they are the same across all cultures.
- **Charles Darwin (1898):** Emotions are a product of evolution and therefore universal.
- Even children blind from birth can produce appropriate facial expressions without ever having witnessed them.

# Role of culture in emotions

**Display rules:** learned ways of controlling displays of emotion in social settings

## Cultural variation

- Regulation of emotional expression: Asian culture (suppression) versus Western culture (openness)
- E.g., biting one's tongue: India versus United States of America

## Gender differences

- Expression of emotions: Women reported extreme negative affect to grief compared to men
- However, when autonomic arousal levels were compared, no significant gender differences
- Men restrained their outward emotions



When is emotional restraint beneficial?  
When is open emotional expression more effective?



(Elfenbein & Ambady, 2002; Haidt & Keltner, 1999; Khosla, 1994)

# Functions of an emotion

## *Prepares us for action*

- If you saw an angry dog charging toward you, your emotional reaction (fear) would be associated with physiological arousal of the sympathetic division of the autonomic nervous system, the activation of the “fight-or-flight” response

## *Shapes our future behaviour*

- Emotions promote learning that will help us make appropriate responses in the future
- For instance, your emotional response to unpleasant events teaches you to avoid similar circumstances in the future

## *Helps us interact more effectively with others*

- We often communicate the emotions we experience through our verbal and nonverbal behaviors, making our emotions obvious to observers
- These behaviors can act as a signal to observers, allowing them to understand better what we are experiencing and to help them predict our future behavior.

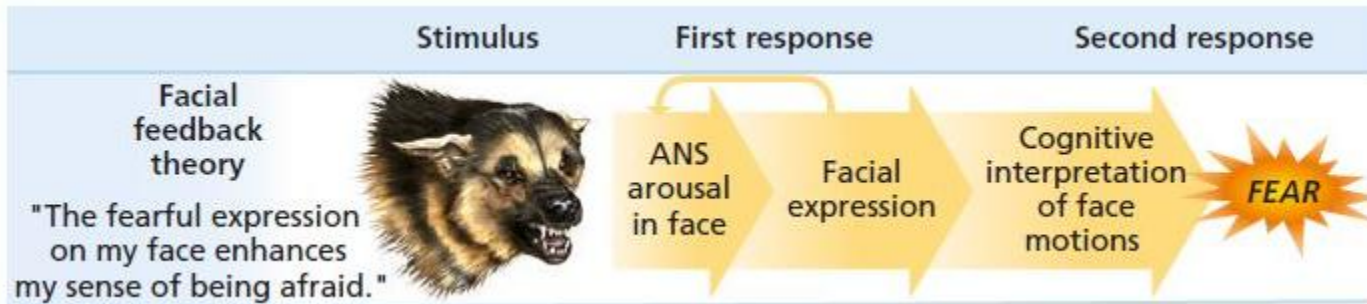
(Frederickson & Branigan, 2005; Frijda, 2005; Gross, 2006)

# Theories of emotion

## Facial Feedback Hypothesis

- Emotions can be influenced by the facial expressions we project
- Provides feedback to the brain
- Facial expression = emotional experience
- However, unable to explain people with a paralysed face

**E.g., we smile when we feel happy, but smiling can also make us feel happy**







@themurkyofficial

# Theories of emotion: Which comes first? The thought or the feeling?

## James-Lange Theory

- Bodily reactions or sensations before emotions
- Focusses on autonomic nervous system (ANS)

### Drawbacks

- People with spinal cord injuries still experience emotions despite lack of sympathetic feedback
- Vagus nerve provides alternative feedback pathway, complicating the theory



Mnemonic tip: Jumpy Legs, then emotion



E.g., I see, I run, I become afraid

# Theories of emotion (con'd...)

## Cannon-Bard Theory

- Emotional experience and bodily reactions occur simultaneously
- Focusses on the thalamus

### Strengths

- Accounts for complex emotions

### Drawbacks

- Quick versus slow cognitive appraisals
- Overemphasis on the thalamus



Mnemonic tip: Cannon's Both at once!



E.g., I see, I experience both fear and a pounding heart,  
and then I run

(Lindquist et al., 2012; Nevid, 2009; Söderkvist et al., 2018)

# Theories of emotion (con'd...)

## Schachter-Singer Theory

- Two-factor model:
  - i) physiological arousal;
  - ii) cognitive interpretation or labelling from Environmental cues

### Strengths

- Accounts for biological and cognitive component

### Drawbacks

- Cognitive appraisal involves more than the external cues



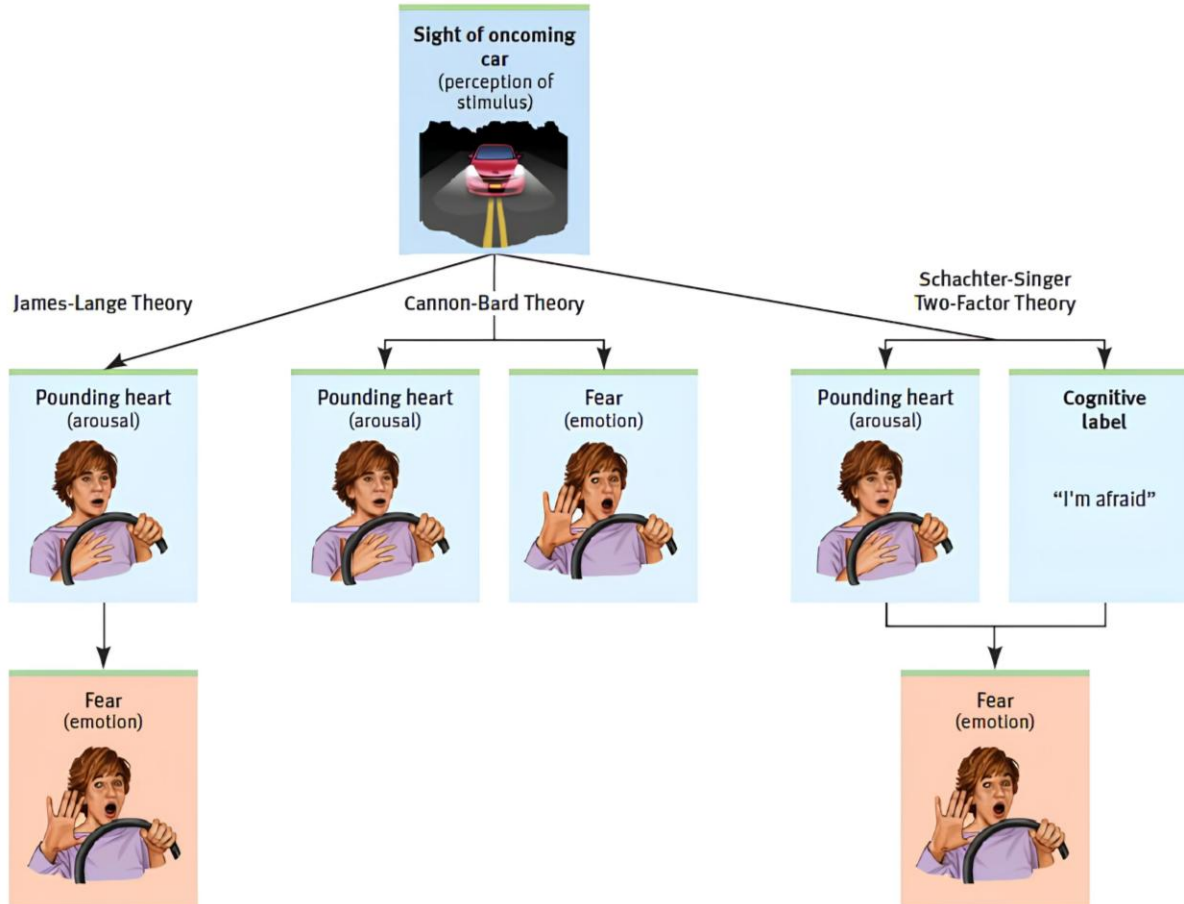
Mnemonic tip: Sweaty and Smart!



E.g., I see, I run, I think, and I become afraid

(Nevid, 2009; Myers, 2010)

# Comparison of the theories of emotion



My daughter saw the anatomy of  
an ant then this happened...😭



(Kyle Winther via ViralHog)